

Algebraic geometry 2026

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August 11, 2026

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Chapter 1

Algebraic sets

1.1 Basic definitions

Some important observations:

- If $\mathbb{F}$ is a finite field, the map which takes a polynomial in $\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and send to a function $\mathbb{F}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{F}$ is not an isomorphism. For example, if $\mathbb{F}$ has q elements, then $\prod_{q \in \mathbb{F}} (X - q) \in \mathbb{F}[X] \mapsto 0$. However, if $\mathbb{F}$ is infinity and $a_n X^n + a_{n-1} X^{n-1} + \dots + a_0 = 0$, then we can select distinct elements $\alpha_0, \dots, \alpha_n$ and we conclude that

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_0 & \dots & a_n \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & \dots & 1 \\ \alpha_0 & \alpha_1 & \dots & \alpha_n \\ \vdots & \vdots & \dots & \vdots \\ \alpha_0^n & \alpha_1^n & \dots & \alpha_n^n \end{pmatrix} = 0. \quad (1.1)$$

However $\det(\alpha_i^j)_{i,j=0}^n = \prod_{i < j} (\alpha_i - \alpha_j) \neq 0$ and we conclude that $a_0, \dots, a_n = 0$. Now, if $f \in \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$, then we can write (assuming X_1 appears in f):

$$f = g_d(X_2, \dots, X_n)X_1^d + \dots + g_1(X_2, \dots, X_n)X_1 + g_0(X_2, \dots, X_n). \quad (1.2)$$

So the equality $f = 0$, the previous step for the case $\mathbb{F}[X]$ and an induction on the number of variables yields $g_d, \dots, g_0 = 0$. Then we see that if $|\mathbb{F}| = \infty$, we can identify the ring $\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ with polynomial functions $\mathbb{F}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{F}$.

As a consequence of this story, we see that if $|\mathbb{F}| = \infty$, then

$$I(\mathbb{F}^n) = (0) \subset \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]. \quad (1.3)$$

- (Hilbert basis theorem). The Hilbert basis theorem states that if A is noetherian, then $A[X]$ is noetherian. Since $\mathbb{F}[X]$ is a PID (and in consequence noetherian), we conclude by an induction on the number of variables that $\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ is noetherian.

Remark 1.1.1. A ring is said to be noetherian if it satisfy the ascending chain condition, or equivalently, if all of its ideals are finitely generated.

- (Algebraic sets). Let $S \subset \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$, then $V(S) = \{a \in \mathbb{F}^n : f(a) = 0\}$. It's immediate that $V(S) = V(\langle S \rangle)$. The relation $V(\bigcup_{i \in I} S_i) = \bigcap_{i \in I} V(S_i)$ allow us to define the Zariski topology on $\mathbb{F}^n$. Moreover, for any subset $V \subset \mathbb{F}^n$, we let $I(V) = \{f \in \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n] : f(a) = 0, \forall a \in V\}$. Then we have

$$\begin{cases} VI(W) = \overline{W} \\ IV(\mathfrak{a}) = \sqrt{\mathfrak{a}} \end{cases} \quad (1.4)$$

We also have the important relation

$$V(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) = V(\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b}) = V(\mathfrak{a}) \cup V(\mathfrak{b}). \quad (1.5)$$

In fact

$$V(\mathfrak{a}) \cup V(\mathfrak{b}) \underset{\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}}{\subset} V(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) \underset{\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}}{\subset} V(\mathfrak{a}\mathfrak{b}) = V(\{fg : f \in \mathfrak{a}, g \in \mathfrak{b}\}) \subset V(\mathfrak{a}) \cup V(\mathfrak{b}). \quad (1.6)$$

- (Coordinate rings). Let $\mathfrak{a} = I(V)$ where V is an algebraic set. We define the coordinate ring $A[V] = \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/\mathfrak{a}$.
- (LEX order). We define an ordering on $\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^n$ by $\alpha > \beta$ if for the smallest i such that $\alpha_i \neq \beta_i$ we have $\alpha_i > \beta_i$. So, with a fixed LEX on $\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$, we can define the leading term of a polynomial: $\text{LT}(f) = a_\alpha X^\alpha$, where α is the smallest tuple, relative to LEX such that $a_\alpha \neq 0$. In the case $\text{LT}(f) = a_\alpha X^\alpha$, we also write $\text{LM}(f) = X^\alpha$.
- (Groebner Basis). Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be an ideal in $\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. A groebner basis of $\mathfrak{a}$ is a finite subset $G \subset \mathfrak{a}$ such that $(\text{LT}(g) : g \in G) = \text{LT}(\mathfrak{a})$.

Example 1.1.2. Let $R = \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n, Y_1, \dots, Y_n]$ with LEX: $X_1 > \dots > X_n > Y_1 > \dots > Y_n$ and define an ideal $\mathfrak{a} = (X_1 - g_1, \dots, X_n - g_n)$ for $g_i \in \mathbb{F}[Y_1, \dots, Y_n]$. Since $\text{LT}(X_i - g_i) = X_i$, it's clear that $(X_1, \dots, X_n) \subset \text{LT}(\mathfrak{a})$. Now, if $f \in R$ and $X_j \nmid \text{LT}(f)$, $\forall j$, then $f \in \mathbb{F}[Y_1, \dots, Y_n]$ because its smallest term has power $\alpha \in \{0\} \times \mathbb{Z}^n$. So, we need to show that $I \cap \mathbb{F}[Y_1, \dots, Y_n] = (0)$. This can be seen by proving that the kernel of $\varphi : R \rightarrow \mathbb{F}[Y] : X_i \mapsto g_i, Y_i \mapsto Y_i$ is I . The only nontrivial inclusion is $\text{Ker}(\varphi) \subset I$. To see this use a division algorithm to write

$$f = h_1(X_1 - g_1) + \dots + h_n(X_n - g_n) + r \quad (1.7)$$

where $r \neq 0$ implies that no term of r is divisible by $\text{LT}(X_i - g_i) = X_i$, $\forall i$. By applying φ on both sides of this equation we have the desired inclusion. From this we see that $G = (X_1 - g_1, \dots, X_n - g_n)$ is a groebner basis for I .

- (Hilbert Polynomial).

Definition 1.1.3. Let $I \subset \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be an ideal. We define the affine Hilbert function:

$${}^a\text{HF}_I : \mathbb{Z}_{>0} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_{>0} : s \mapsto \dim_{\mathbb{F}} \left(\frac{\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]_{\leq s}}{I_{\leq s}} \right). \quad (1.8)$$

Example 1.1.4. For example, the number ${}^a\text{HF}_{(0)}(s)$ is the number of n -tuples of nonnegative integers whose sum is $\leq s$. To compute this, write the generating function

$$\prod_{i=1}^n \frac{1}{1 - X_i} = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^n} X^\alpha. \quad (1.9)$$

Now put $X_i = t$, $\forall i$. We see that

$$(1 - t)^{-n} = \sum_{s \geq 0} \binom{-n}{s} (-1)^s t^s = \sum_{s \geq 0} \binom{n+s}{s} t^s. \quad (1.10)$$

So ${}^a\text{HF}_{(0)}(s) = \binom{n+s}{s} = \frac{1}{n!} s^n + \dots$.

Example 1.1.5. Let $f \in \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be a degree d polynomial. Then

$${}^a\text{HF}_{(f)}(s) = \binom{s+n}{s} - \binom{s-d+n}{s-d} = \frac{d}{(n-1)!} s^{n-1} + \dots. \quad (1.11)$$

An important property of the affine Hilbert function is the following:

Theorem 1.1.6. Let $I \subset \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ be an ideal, then

$${}^a\text{HF}_I(s) = {}^a\text{HF}_{\text{LT}(I)}(s), \quad s \geq 0. \quad (1.12)$$

Another main result is the existence of the Hilbert polynomial.

Theorem 1.1.7. There exist a polynomial ${}^a\text{HP}_I(t) \in \mathbb{Q}[t]$ such that

$${}^a\text{HP}_I(s) = {}^a\text{HF}_I(s), \quad \forall s \geq 0. \quad (1.13)$$

Proof (sketch):

- Find a Groebner basis G of I
- Let $M \subset \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^n$ be such that $\{X^\beta\}_{\beta \in M} = \{\text{LM}(g) : g \in G\}$
- Write

$$C(I) = \bigcap_{\beta \in M} C(\beta), \quad C(\beta) = \{\alpha | X^\beta \nmid X^\alpha\} \quad (1.14)$$

as a union of $C(J, \tau) = \{\alpha | \alpha_j = \tau(j) \forall j \in J\}$. To do this use

$$C(\beta) = \bigcup_{i=1}^n \bigcup_{t_i=0}^{\beta_i-1} C(\{i\}, \tau : i \mapsto t_i). \quad (1.15)$$

- Use the formula $|C(J, \tau)_{\leq s}| = \binom{d+s-|\tau|}{d}, d = n - |J|, |\tau| = \sum_{j \in J} \tau(j)$ and the inclusion-exclusion principle to compute

$${}^a\text{HP}_I(s) = |C(I)_{\leq s}| = \left| \bigcup_{(J, \tau)} C(J, \tau)_{\leq s} \right|. \quad (1.16)$$

Example 1.1.8. Let $I = (X_1 - X_3^2, X_2 - X_3^3)$ and fix the LEX order with $X_1 > X_2 > X_3$. Then we calculate

- $G = \{X_1 - X_3^2, X_2 - X_3^3\}$
- $M = \{(1, 0, 0), (0, 1, 0)\}$
- We have

$$\begin{aligned} C(I) &= C(\{1\}, \tau : 1 \mapsto 0) \cap C(\{2\}, \tau : 2 \mapsto 0) \\ &= C(\{1, 2\}, \tau : 1 \mapsto 0, 2 \mapsto 0). \end{aligned} \quad (1.17)$$

So we conclude that $|C(I)|_{\leq s} = \binom{1+s-0}{1} = s + 1$.

- (Algebraic dimension). Here we define the dimension of an algebraic set.

Definition 1.1.9. Let $V \subset \mathbb{F}^n$ be an algebraic set. We define its dimension as $\dim(V) = \deg {}^a\text{HP}_{I(V)}(t)$. It has the property that it's the biggest integer $d \geq 1$ such that there exist indexes $1 \leq i_1 < \dots < i_d \leq n$ such that $I(V) \cap \mathbb{F}[X_{i_1}, \dots, X_{i_d}] = (0)$.

Example 1.1.10. Let $H_f = V(f)$, f irreducible, then

$$\begin{aligned} \dim(H_f) &= \deg {}^a\text{HP}_{I(H_f)}(t) \\ &= \deg {}^a\text{HP}_{(f)}(t) \\ &= \deg\left(\frac{\deg(f)}{(n-1)!}t^{n-1} + \dots\right) \\ &= n - 1. \end{aligned} \quad (1.18)$$

The dimension has the expected property: If $W \subset V$ is closed, then $\dim(W) \leq \dim(V)$. In fact

$$\begin{aligned} I(V) \subset I(W) &\Rightarrow \\ I(V)_{\leq s} \subset I(W)_{\leq s} &\Rightarrow \\ {}^a\text{HF}_{I(W)}(s) \leq {}^a\text{HF}_{I(V)}(s), \forall s \geq 0 &\Rightarrow \\ \deg {}^a\text{HF}_{I(W)}(t) \leq \deg {}^a\text{HF}_{I(V)}(t). \end{aligned} \quad (1.19)$$

- (Transcendence degree). Let A be a finitely generated $\mathbb{F}$ -algebra. We define the transcendence degree of A over $\mathbb{F}$ (and write $\partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A)$) to be largest size of an algebraically independent subset of A over $\mathbb{F}$.

Example 1.1.11. We have $\partial_{\mathbb{F}}(\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]) = n$. Indeed, let $\{f_1, \dots, f_r\}$ be polynomials and suppose that $r > n$. Write

$$\begin{aligned} W_s &= \{f^\beta : \beta \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^r, |\beta| \leq s\}, \quad d = \max\{\deg(f_i) : i = 1, \dots, r\} \\ V_s &= \{X^\alpha : |\alpha| \leq s\} \end{aligned} \quad (1.20)$$

Then $W_s \subset V_{ds}$ and

$$|W_s| = \binom{r+s}{s} \stackrel{s \gg 0}{\geq} \binom{n+sd}{sd} = \dim(V_{sd}) \geq \dim(W_s). \quad (1.21)$$

So, for $s \gg 0$ there exist $\{a_\beta\}_\beta \subset \mathbb{F}$ such that $\sum_\beta a_\beta f^\beta = 0$ and $\{f_1, \dots, f_r\}$ is algebraically dependent.

Theorem 1.1.12. Let V be an algebraic set and write $I = I(V)$, then

$$\dim(V) = \partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V]) = \partial_{\mathbb{F}}\left(\frac{\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]}{I}\right). \quad (1.22)$$

Proof: Let $d = \dim(V)$, so there exist indexes $1 \leq i_1 < \dots < i_d \leq n$ such that $I \cap \mathbb{F}[X_{i_1}, \dots, X_{i_d}] = (0)$. This is equivalent to say that $[X_{i_1}], \dots, [X_{i_d}] \in A[V]$ are algebraically independent over $\mathbb{F}$. Therefore $d \leq \partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V])$. Now, suppose that $\varphi_i = [f_i] \in A[V], i = 1, \dots, m$ are algebraically independent over $\mathbb{F}$ and put $N = \max \deg(f_i)$, then the map

$$\mathbb{F}[Y_1, \dots, Y_m]_{\leq s} \mapsto \frac{\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]_{\leq Ns}}{I_{\leq Ns}} : g \mapsto g(\varphi_1, \dots, \varphi_m) \quad (1.23)$$

is injective. Then, by taking dimensions we get

$$\binom{m+s}{s} \leq {}^a\text{HF}_I(s), \quad \forall s \geq 0. \quad (1.24)$$

We know that both expressions are polynomials in s , so by taking degrees we conclude that $m \leq \dim(V) = d$ and $\partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V]) \leq d$. $\square$

With small changes in the above proof, we can verify that in the case of $A[V]$ being an integral domain, we have also $\partial_{\mathbb{F}}(K) = \dim(V)$, $K = \text{Frac}(A[V])$.

Example 1.1.13. Let $C = V(X_1 - X_3^2, X_1 - X_3^3)$, then $I(C) = (X_1 - X_3^2, X_2 - X_3^3)$ and

$$\frac{\mathbb{F}[X_1, X_2, X_3]}{I(C)} \cong \mathbb{F}[X_3] \quad (1.25)$$

so $\partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A[C]) = 1$.

Example 1.1.14. The purpose of this example is to show that if $V \subset \mathbb{F}^n, |\mathbb{F}| = \infty$ is a linear space, then $\dim(V) = \dim_{\mathbb{F}}(V)$.

- Let $\text{Ann}(V) = \text{Span}(f_1, \dots, f_m)$. Since V has finite dimension, we have $v \in V \iff f(v) = 0 \forall f \in \text{Ann}(V)$ and $V = V(\{f_1, \dots, f_m\})$.
- Let $f_i = \sum a_{ij} X_j$, where we identify X_j with the j th coordinate functions in $\mathbb{F}^n$. Now, if $A = (a_{ij})$ and apply reduction to put A in the form:

$$\begin{pmatrix} a_{1j_1} & * & 0 & * & \cdots & 0 & \cdots \\ & & a_{2j_2} & * & \cdots & 0 & \cdots \\ & & & & \ddots & \cdots & \vdots \\ & & & & & 0 & \cdots & a_{mj_m} & \cdots \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.26)$$

with $a_{ij_i} = 1$, $j_1 < j_2 < \dots$. Now put LEX with: $X_{j_1} > \dots > X_{j_m} > X_j$ $j \notin \{j_1, \dots, j_m\}$ and write $f_i = X_{j_i} + h_i$ with $h_i \in \mathbb{F}[X_j : j \notin \{j_1, \dots, j_m\}]$. Then we see that $A[V] \cong \mathbb{F}[X_j : j \notin \{j_1, \dots, j_m\}]$ and $(f_1, \dots, f_m)$ is prime. Therefore $I(V) = (f_1, \dots, f_m)$. Finally

$$\dim(V) = \partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V]) = \dim_{\mathbb{F}} \mathbb{F}[X_j : j \notin \{j_1, \dots, j_m\}] = \dim_{\mathbb{F}} V. \quad (1.27)$$

1.2 Tangent Spaces

- (Regular maps). Let $V \subset \mathbb{F}^m, W \subset \mathbb{F}^n$ be algebraic sets. Then a map $f : V \rightarrow W$ is said to be regular if there exist polynomials such that $f = (f_1, \dots, f_m)$. Such a map is continuous in the Zariski topology.

Remark 1.2.1. We can identify $A[V]$ with the set of regular functions $V \rightarrow \mathbb{F}$. In this context, we have a contravariant functor:

$$\varphi : V \rightarrow W \rightsquigarrow \varphi^* : A[W] \rightarrow A[V] : [g] \mapsto [g] \circ \varphi \quad (1.28)$$

Example 1.2.2. Let $\varphi : \mathbb{F} \rightarrow C : x \mapsto (x^3, x^2, x)$ and write $C = (X_1 - X_3^2, X_2 - X_3^3)$. Remember the isomorphism $A[C] \rightarrow \mathbb{F}[Y] : [X_1] \mapsto Y^2, [X_2] \mapsto Y^3, [X_3] \mapsto Y$. So we have

$$\varphi^* : A[C] \rightarrow A[\mathbb{F}] : [X_3] \mapsto [X_3] \circ \varphi. \quad (1.29)$$

The first map is $[X_3] : C \rightarrow \mathbb{F} : (x^3, x^2, x) \mapsto x$ and the last map is $\mathbb{F} \rightarrow C : x \mapsto x$. At the algebraic level, the map φ^* is just the isomorphism $\mathbb{F}[Y] \cong \mathbb{F}[X]$.

- (Tangent spaces). Let V be an algebraic set and $V_p = \mathbb{F}$ be the $A[V]$ -module with action $[f]\alpha \equiv f(p)\alpha$. Let $I(V) = (f_1, \dots, f_m)$. We define

$$\begin{aligned} T_p(V) &= \{v \in \mathbb{F}^n : d(f)_p(v) = 0 \forall f \in I(V)\} \\ &= \{v \in \mathbb{F}^n : d(f_i)_p(v) = 0 \forall i\} \\ &= V(\{d(f_i)_p : i = 1, \dots, m\}) \end{aligned} \quad (1.30)$$

Remark 1.2.3. Caution ! The polynomials of f_i here are not the generators of V , but of $I(V)$. For example, if $V = V(f)$, we can conclude that $T_p(V) = V(df_p)$ only if f is irreducible, i.e., if $I(V) = (f)$.

Here $df_p \equiv \sum_{i=1}^n D_i(f)(p)X_i \in \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. We have an isomorphism

$$T_p(V) \rightarrow \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V], V_p) : v \mapsto D_v; \quad D_v([f]) = \sum_{i=1}^n [D_i(f)] \cdot v_i \in \mathbb{F}. \quad (1.31)$$

with inverse $D \mapsto (D([X_i]))_{i=1}^n$. Of course $D_v([f]) = df_p(v)$.

Maybe it will be better to change notation of V_p to ${}^p\mathbb{F}$ or something.

Example 1.2.4. Let $C = (f_1, f_2)$, $f_1 = X_1 - X_3^2$, $f_2 = X_2 - X_3^3$ and $p = (x^3, x^2, x) \in C$. We have

$$d(f_1)_p = 1 - 2xX_3, \quad d(f_2)_p = 1 - 3x^2X_3 \quad (1.32)$$

and $T_p(C) = \mathbb{F}\langle (3x^2, 2x, 1) \rangle$.

Example 1.2.5. The determinant is an irreducible polynomial. Indeed, let $\det \in \mathbb{F}[X_{ij} : 1 \leq i, j \leq n]$. Then, if we apply Laplace theorem on the first row, we get

$$\det = A_{11}X_{11} - A_{12}X_{12} + \dots + (-1)^n A_{1n}X_n \quad (1.33)$$

where A_{ij} denotes the determinant of the matrix obtained by excluding the i th row and j th column. By induction on the number of variables, we assume that A_{ij} are irreducible polynomials. Now, suppose that $\det = fg$, where $\deg(f), \deg(g) > 0$. Choose LEX with $X_{ij} > X_{k\ell}$ if $i < k$ or if $i = k$ and $j < \ell$. Then

$$\text{LT}(A_{11})X_{11} = \text{LT}(\det) = \text{LT}(f)\text{LT}(g). \quad (1.34)$$

Assume that $X_{11} | \text{LT}(f)$ (so $\text{LT}(g) < X_{11}$) and write $f = AX_{11} + B$, $\text{LT}(B) < X_{11}$. Then we must have $AgX_{11} = A_{11}X_{11}$ and $A_{11} = Ag$. Since $\deg(g) > 1$ and A_{11} is irreducible, we must have $g = A_{11}$ and $A = 1$. Now we get

$$-A_{12}X_{12} + \dots + (-1)^n A_{1n}X_n = BA_{11} \quad (1.35)$$

and $-\text{LT}(A_{12})X_{12} = \text{LT}(B)\text{LT}(A_{11})$. Since $X_{22} | \text{LT}(A_{11})$, we are led to $X_{22} | \text{LT}(A_{12})$ which is a contradiction because X_{22} doesn't appear in A_{12} by definition.

Now, since $\det$ is an irreducible homogeneous polynomial, the difference $\det - 1$ must be irreducible. Therefore $I(SL_n \mathbb{F}) = (\det - 1)$ and we can compute the tangent space

$T_I(SL_n) = V(d_I(\det))$. We have

$$\begin{aligned}
d_I \det &= \sum_{k,\ell} D_{k\ell}(\det)(I) X_{k\ell} \\
&= \sum_{k,\ell} \sum_{\sigma \in S_n} D_{k\ell} \prod_{i=1}^n X_{i\sigma(i)}(I) X_{k\ell} \\
&= \sum_{k,\ell} \sum_{\sigma \in S_n} \delta_{\ell,\sigma(k)} \prod_{i \neq k} \delta_{i,\sigma(i)} X_{k\ell} \\
&= \sum_{k,\ell} \delta_{k\ell} X_{k\ell} \quad (\delta_{\ell,\sigma(k)} \prod_{i \neq k} \delta_{i,\sigma(i)} \neq 0 \text{ only if } \sigma = 1) \\
&= \sum_k X_{kk}.
\end{aligned} \tag{1.36}$$

Therefore $T_I SL_n(\mathbb{F}) = \mathfrak{sl}_n \mathbb{F}$, the Lie algebra of traceless matrices.

- (Gauss lemma). We state the Gauss lemma.

Lemma 1.2.6. Let R be a UFD ring (think in $\mathbb{F}[X]$), then $R[X]$ is a UFD.

Proof: Let f and $K = \text{Frac}(R)$. Since $K[X]$ is a UFD, we have $f = FG$, $F, G \in K[X]$ with F irreducible and $\deg(G) < \deg(f)$. Since R is a UFD, there exist $r, s \in R$ such that $rF, sG \in R[X]$. Decompose $rs = t_1 \cdots t_k$ into irreducible elements. Then if $F' = rF, G' = sG$, we have

$$[F'][G'] = [rs][f] = 0 \in R/(t_i)[X] \tag{1.37}$$

because $f \in R[X]$. So, since $R/(t_i)[X]$ is a domain, we see that $t_i | F'$ or $t_i | G'$. Then we see that there exist a partition $\{1, \dots, k\} = I \cup J$ such that $F' / \prod_{i \in I} t_i, G' / \prod_{j \in J} t_j \in R[X]$. It's clear that F' still irreducible, then an induction on degree yields the result. $\square$

Corollary 1.2.7. Let $f, g \in R = \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ and assume f irreducible with $f \nmid g$, then there exist $F, G \in R$ such that

$$Gf + Fg = h \in \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}] \setminus 0. \tag{1.38}$$

Proof: Let $K = \text{Frac}(\mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}])$, then $f, g \in K[X_n]$ and there exist $A, B \in K[X_n]$ such that $Af + Bg = 1$ (by Gauss lemma f still irreducible as an element of $K[X_n]$). Then there exist $h \in \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}]$ such that $hA, hB \in \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}]$. So by writing $G = hA, F = hB$ we are done. $\square$

Notation 1.2.8. Let $A = \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/I$, where M is a A -module. We write

$$\mathcal{T}_{A,M} = \{(v_1, \dots, v_n) \in M^n : \sum_i [D_i(f)] \cdot v_i, \forall f \in I\}. \tag{1.39}$$

We have the isomorphism $\mathcal{T}_{A,M} \rightarrow \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A, M) : v \mapsto D_v$ with inverse

$$D \mapsto (D(\overline{X_i}))_{i=1}^n. \quad (1.40)$$

Now consider the following context, let $K = \text{Frac}(A)$ as A -module (A acts by multiplication). Then we have an isomorphism

$$\text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(K, K) \rightarrow \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A, K) : D \mapsto D|_A. \quad (1.41)$$

In particular we also have the isomorphism $\mathcal{T}_{A,K} \cong \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(K, K)$. We observe that this is also a K -vector space isomorphism, it's a bijection compatible with the K -action. From this isomorphism, we see that $\mathcal{T}_{A,K}$ only depends on K , and the fact that $\text{Frac}(A) = K$.

Theorem 1.2.9. Let $A = \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/I$ be a domain and $K = \text{Frac}(A)$. Then

$$\partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A) = \dim_K \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(K, K). \quad (1.42)$$

Proof: Let $d = \partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A) = \partial_{\mathbb{F}}(K)$, then there exist $z_1, \dots, z_{d+1}$ such that

- $K = \mathbb{F}(z_1, \dots, z_{d+1})$
- $\{z_1, \dots, z_d\}$ is algebraically independent
- z_d is separable over $\mathbb{F}(z_1, \dots, z_d)$

Let $R = \mathbb{F}[z_1, \dots, z_{d+1}] \subset K$ and $f \neq 0$ irreducible such that $f(z_1, \dots, z_{d+1}) = 0$. Then by corollary (1.2.7), we see that $\alpha : K[Y_1, \dots, Y_{d+1}] \rightarrow K : g \mapsto g(z_1, \dots, z_{d+1})$ has kernel (f) . Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{T}_{R,K} &= \{(v_1, \dots, v_{d+1}) \in K^{d+1} : \sum_i [D_i(f)] \cdot v_i = 0\} \\ &= \{(v_1, \dots, v_{d+1}) \in K^{d+1} : \sum_i D_i(f)(z_1, \dots, z_{d+1}) \cdot v_i = 0\}. \end{aligned} \quad (1.43)$$

We see that $D_i(f)(z_1, \dots, z_{d+1}) = 0 \Rightarrow D_i(f) \in (f)$ and $D_i(f) = 0$. Since $f \neq 0$ and $|\mathbb{F}| = \infty$, we must have $D_i(f) \neq 0$ for some i , so $D_i(f)(z_1, \dots, z_{d+1}) \neq 0$ for some i . Then we conclude that

$$\dim_K \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(K, K) = \dim_K \mathcal{T}_{R,K} = d = \partial_{\mathbb{F}}(K) = \partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A). \quad (1.44)$$

□

Corollary 1.2.10. If $A = \mathbb{F}[X_1, \dots, X_n]/(f_1, \dots, f_m)$, then

$$\partial_{\mathbb{F}}(A) = \dim_K \mathcal{T}_{A,K} = n - \text{Rank}_K([D_i(f_j)]). \quad (1.45)$$

Example 1.2.11. Let $C = V(f_1, f_2)$, $f_1 = X_1 - X_3^2$, $f_2 = X_2 - X_3^3$. We have

$$A[C] = \frac{\mathbb{F}[X_1, X_2, X_3]}{(f_1, f_2)} \rightarrow \mathbb{F}[X_3] : [g] \mapsto g(X_3^3, X_3^2, X_3). \quad (1.46)$$

So $A[C]$ is a domain and we can define $K = \text{Frac}(A[C])$. We compute

$$\text{Rank}_K([D_i(f_j)]) = \text{Rank}_K \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & -2[X_3] \\ 0 & 1 & -3[X_3] \end{pmatrix} = 2. \quad (1.47)$$

Then we conclude $\dim(V) = 3 - 2 = 1$.

- (differential of a regular map). Here we define the notion of differential of a regular map.

Definition 1.2.12. Let $\varphi : V \rightarrow W$ be a regular map between algebraic varieties. Also, let $p \in V, q = \varphi(p) \in W$. We define:

$$d\varphi_p : \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V], V_p) \rightarrow \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A[W], W_q) : D_v \mapsto D_v \circ \varphi^* \quad (1.48)$$

At the level of tangent spaces, we have:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V], V_p) & \xrightarrow{d\varphi_p} & \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A[W], W_q) \\ \uparrow & & \downarrow \\ T_p(V) & \xrightarrow{\quad\quad\quad} & T_q(W) \\ & \uparrow \text{red} & \downarrow \text{red} \\ & v & (D_v \circ \varphi^*([Y_i]))_{i=1}^m \end{array}$$

(Note: The diagram shows a commutative square with red arrows. The top horizontal arrow is $d\varphi_p$. The left vertical arrow is the inclusion $T_p(V) \hookrightarrow \text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A[V], V_p)$. The right vertical arrow is the map $\text{Der}_{\mathbb{F}}(A[W], W_q) \rightarrow T_q(W)$. The bottom horizontal arrow is the map $T_p(V) \rightarrow T_q(W)$. The red arrows show the relationship $D_v \mapsto D_v \circ \varphi^*$ and $v \mapsto (D_v \circ \varphi^*([Y_i]))_{i=1}^m$.)

In more details, if we write $\varphi = (f_1, \dots, f_m)$, then $\varphi^*([Y_i]) = [f_i]$ and we get

$$D_v([f_i]) = \sum_{j=1}^m [D_j(f_i)] \cdot v_j = \sum_{j=1}^m D_j(f_i)(p) v_j. \quad (1.49)$$

Therefore

$$d\varphi_p(v) = (D_j(f_i)(p))_{i,j} \cdot v = J_p(\varphi) \cdot v. \quad (1.50)$$

Example 1.2.13. Let $G \subset \mathbb{F}^{n^2}$ be an algebraic group and $\mu : G \times G \rightarrow G$ be the product of matrices. We have $G \times G \subset \mathbb{F}^{n^2} \times \mathbb{F}^{n^2} \cong \mathbb{F}^{2n^2}$. Now, identify the first n^2

coordinate functions with X_{ij} and the second n^2 coordinate functions with Y_{ij} . So we have

$$\mu_{ij} = \sum_{\ell} X_{i\ell} Y_{\ell j}. \quad (1.51)$$

Then we have

$$\frac{\partial \mu_{ij}}{\partial X_{rs}}(I) = \frac{\partial \mu_{ij}}{\partial Y_{rs}}(I) = \delta_{ir} \delta_{sj}. \quad (1.52)$$

Therefore

$$d_{(I,I)}\mu(A, B) = \left(\sum_{r,s} \frac{\partial \mu_{ij}}{\partial X_{rs}}(I) A_{rs} + \frac{\partial \mu_{ij}}{\partial Y_{rs}}(I) B_{rs} \right)_{ij} = (A_{ij} + B_{ij}) = A + B. \quad (1.53)$$

TODO:

1. Prove that T_1G is a Lie algebra. Remember the star operator.
2. Compute the Lie algebra of SL_n using the fact that $\det -1$ is an irreducible polynomial.